QP CODE :24900136

**MAHATMA GANDHI UNIVERSITY, KOTTAYAM**

**FIRST SEMESTER MGU-UGP(HONOURS) REGULAR EXAMINATION**

**NOVEMBER 2024**

**Multi-Disciplinary Course- MG1MDCHIS100- FLAVOURS OF THE PAST AND PRESENT- FOOD, CULTURE**

(2024 ADMISSION ONWARDS)

**Part A**

Short Answer Questions

Answer any 5 Questions

Each question carries 2 marks

1) Subsistence farming system- combination of crop cultivation with livestock rearing- steady supply of food throughout the year
2) Introduction of new ingredients like dry fruits and nuts, saffron - new cooking methods such as *dum* , grilling and roasting, new dishes like kebabs and pulao(pilaf), emphasis on meat consumption - regional variations
3) Purity and pollution regarding meat consumption – segregated kitchens- caste hierarchies and related culinary patterns (from strict vegetarianism to wide range of diets)
4) Agricultural Revolution, plant and animal domestication- emergence of settlements- technological advancements (farming tools, wheel, pottery making...,).
5) Buddhist and Jain philosophies -Promotion of vegetarianism, ethical perspectives on food preparation and consumption.
6) Nonviolence, Ahimsa- Vegetarianism- ethical considerations
7) “India – the land of spices”- Malabar spice trade with black pepper- spice routes- European colonization.
8) Tea plantations- colonial influence on widespread consumption of tea- chai-Social roles and hospitality.

**Part-B**

Short essays- Answer any 4 questions

Each Question carries 5 marks

9) Deforestation and habitat loss- climate change- greenhouse gas emissions- water use and pollutions- bio diversity loss- over exploitation and consumption- soil degradation- waste.
10) Food and Purity-Vegetarianism-Food segregation- Satwik and Tamasik diet norms- pollution rituals- pure Vs impure foods.
11) Shift to lower quality food substitutes- dependence on cheap grains and reduction in protein consumption – popularity of potatoes and tapioca- alterations in agricultural patterns.
12) Hunting and gathering, raw meat, invention of fire and introduction of cooked food- fishing- shift to agriculture- agro- pastoralism-tool developments- surplus production.
13) Purity and Pollution-beef taboo -Forbidden Foods for Lower Castes -Dietary Restrictions Based on Caste-Brahmins, -expected to consume vegetarian food, kshatriyas and merchants (Vaishyas) might have had more freedom to consume meat. Shudras, the lowest caste, often ate whatever was available, including food that was "leftover" not properly prepared according to the higher-caste standards. -depictions of feasts and rituals in the Mahabharata- depictions of various types of food according to Ayurveda.
14) Extensive use of meats like lamb-use of spices like saffron, cardamom, and rosewater- slow cooking techniques and tandoor-grand Mughal kitchens - innovative use of ingredients and the integration of regional food cultures-rich gravies, made from yogurt, cream, nuts-dishes-biryani, pulao, korma, kebabs, nihari etc
15) Introduction of new vegetables like chillies, potatoes and tomatoes- replacing black pepper with chilli as a substitute for spiciness- adaptation of new technics such as pickling , brewing, incorporation of new food preservation technologies, introduction of curry powder- use of refined sugar- baking and bread making- development of Goan cuisine -tea culture – new alcoholic beverages.

**Part 3**

Essay , Answer any 2 questions

Each question carries 10 marks

16) Ability to control fire- increased digestibility- energy efficiency and bio availability of foods-reduction of toxins and pathogens decreased the dangers of diseases -dietary expansion to legumes, seeds and grains- regular meal timings- tool and skill developments- development of new cooking techniques- fire as a weapon and as a deterrence -development of communities.
17) Diverse cultures,castes and religions- religious feasts- temple gatherings and *annadanams*-communal feasts during ramadan milad and Eid-notions of shared meals during church festivals-*nercha kanji*, a rice based porridge with sweetness of jaggery- sadya- and rice porridge with yam *puzhukk* served during temple festivals- harvest festivals, especially Onam- Social roles of community kitchens-use of community kitchens during Temple entry movements and other social reform movements- expressions like *Panthi bhojanam, Misra bhojanam*- modern day community kitchens during disaster relief activities, state sponsored initiatives like Janakeeya Hotels, kudumbasree –women empowerment- breaking barriers of caste- religious tensions-fostering unity.
18) Introduction of commercial cultivation of tea and coffee- inclusion of new beverages as part of daily routine –"tea time"- diversified snacking habits – caffein dependency and addiction- Tea

and coffee as energy drinks, psychological aspects-popularizing sugar as a source of sweetness- as a symbol od modernity- tea and coffee houses as spaces of social interactions-colonial modernity- tea as a popular middle class drink while coffee as an urban phenomenon- filter coffee as a popular substitute for elite coffee drinks-impact of globalization and introduction of expensive coffee based drinks such espresso and latte- popularity of Starbucks in the modern era- development of cottage industries around high altitude localities-tea culture- hospitality.

19) Evolution of Vegetarianism in India- Influence of Brahminism- Notions od Ahimsa- Ethical and moral constraints of dietary choices- diet as an affirmation of Purity- Influence of social reform movements in promoting vegetarian diets as part of self-discipline- control over women's diet as part of purity, health concerns due to insufficient protein intake- class and caste distinctions in diets, vegetarianism often associates with affluent classes while economically lower sections consumes a wide range of meat-vegetarianism symbolize a privilege – non vegetarian exclusions in some public institutions like schools and universities- recent social stigmas related to non vegetarianism , a dilemma to the middle classes and marginalized communities like tribals- plant based expensive substititutes like nuts – stigmas arising out of meat consumption created when working as house help- holy cow sentiments- cow politics-violence of meat consumption-assertion of identity.